

EUROPE

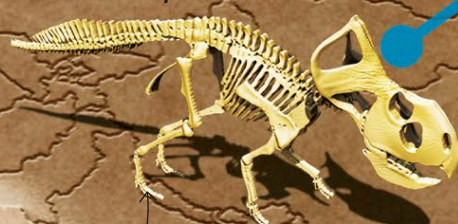
Our knowledge of prehistoric creatures began in Europe in the early 1800s, when the very first dinosaurs to be named were discovered in the UK. There are fossil-rich sites across the continent, such as Solnhofen in Germany, where the winged *Archaeopteryx* was found.

SOLNHOFEN, GERMANY



Archaeopteryx

Protoceratops

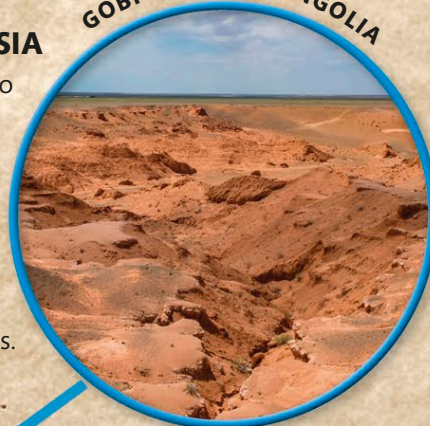


Fossils of this small herbivore are common in the rocks of Mongolia.

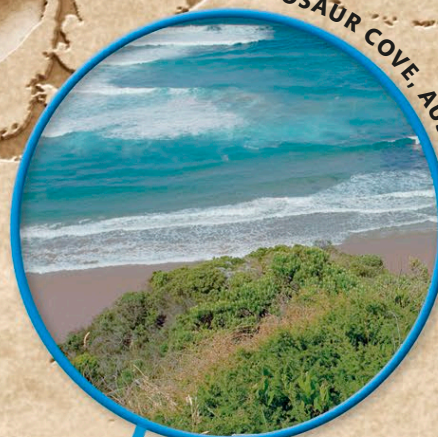
ASIA

This continent is home to some remarkable fossils, many of which can be found within its unique rock formations, as seen in the Gobi Desert. In China, amber specimens have preserved the soft tissues of some dinosaurs and prehistoric animals.

GOBI DESERT, MONGOLIA



DINOSAUR COVE, AUSTRALIA



AUSTRALIA

Fossils of prehistoric animals from Australia are rare. Dinosaur fossils were first discovered there in 1903, at a site now known as Dinosaur Cove. Recent finds include one spectacular set of bones, which have a blue color because they were fossilized in opal.

A well-preserved pliosaur fossil was discovered in Queensland in 1990.

Pliosaur



TÉNÉRÉ DESERT, NIGER



AFRICA

The vast deserts and steamy rainforests of Africa make this continent a tricky place to go looking for fossils. However, in recent years, many areas—such as the fossil deposits in the Ténéré Desert—have been found to be rich in ancient life, and fascinating finds have become increasingly common.

ANTARCTICA

A harsh climate and vast inaccessible areas make Antarctica one of the most hostile places on Earth. However, this region was covered in lush forests during the Jurassic Period and would have teemed with life. Paleontologists need special equipment to reach fossil sites and have only found a few specimens among the hard rocks so far.



Mt. Kirkpatrick, Antarctica